

Poco F5

Marvellous mid-ranger

The Poco F5 comes from a lineage of proper powerhouse smartphones like the Pocophone F1 or the Poco F4 5G from last year. Now, we know that its specifications hint at a proper performance champ, but just how good is the Poco F5? Let's find out:

DESIGN

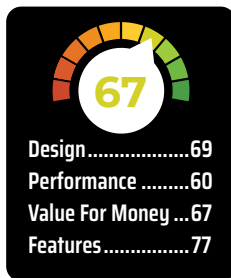
With the Poco F5, we don't see anything interesting. But I like how the smartphone looks and feels. It's basic, it's lightweight, and it has a proportionate form factor. Over and above, the Poco F5 also looks super sleek from the front. At the back, we get a polycarbonate back panel, and the cameras also protrude out of the back panel itself, instead of a separate module that holds them.

DISPLAY

The display on the Poco F5 is stunning. If the specs didn't, let me tell you the display is nothing short of stunning. The colours are accurate, the image quality is vibrant, and the responsiveness is as good as it gets at 120Hz. There were times when the display felt a bit dull in terms of colour. However, take things on to other apps like Netflix and Amazon Prime Video, the image looks super sharp and crisp. This is also one of the brightest displays with a Lux Meter reading of 899 nits, along with a minimum brightness of 19 nits. Like the maximum, the minimum tested brightness on the Poco F5 is also one of the highest in all the smartphones in this range

PERFORMANCE

With DNA shared with powerhouses like Poco F1 or the Poco F4, the Poco F5 is also a beast when it comes to performance. Using the latest Snapdragon 7+ Gen 2,



the Poco F5 is able to achieve one of the highest-ever score of 936,155 points on AnTuTu. Not just AnTuTu, even other CPU-based benchmarks like Geekbench 6, the Poco F5 is the highest-scoring mid-range smartphone that has made its way into Digit's Test Lab here in Noida. Proper flagship

territory. The storage speeds are also the highest on the Poco F5, when compared with rivals. The only storage metric where the Poco F5 lagged behind one specific competing device is the random write speed, where the iQOO Neo 7 does better, but the difference is only marginal. The smartphone uses a 5,000mAh battery, which lasted a good 766 minutes (12.76 hours) in our video loop test. This is brilliant battery backup. Charging is also super-fast at 67W.

CAMERA

With the Poco F5, the camera performance, again impressed me quite a bit on the Poco F5. Images from the primary shooter are especially good. Be it the dynamic range, colour accuracy, or amount of detail, the photos from this primary shooter are very good. Even in 2x optical zoom, the images don't lose any detail or colour. In low light also,

the primary shooter does well to retain details and keep the colours accurate. However, the camera really struggles in confusing lighting conditions. The portraits on the Poco F5 are also good, but not the best we have seen in this segment. The smartphone's edge detection isn't that smooth, and in portrait, the images aren't very detailed, plus the images in portrait mode also lack detail. Front camera is also great in terms of detail retention and colours.

VERDICT

So that was the Poco F5. The smartphone has entered a highly competitive mid-range segment, against some already very highly-rated smartphones like the Vivo V27 Pro and the iQOO Neo 7. However, the Poco F5 still holds its own. The new Snapdragon 7+ Gen 2 chipset closes the gap further between flagship and mid-range smartphones when it comes to performance, resulting in the Poco F5 showing us one of the highest-ever CPU benchmark scores so far.

The Poco F5 also looks and feels great, and we get a stunning 12-bit pOLED display which just looks super immersive. The camera is also great, and we get some other much-appreciated features like Corning Gorilla Glass protection, a 3.5mm headphone jack, and a very lightweight build. There are shortcomings in the camera and display department, but the raw power and speed that the Poco F5 offers makes it a tough choice between this and the iQOO Neo 7 as your next mid-range gaming smartphone!

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Display Size: 16.94 cm (6.67 inch) | Resolution: 2400 x 1080 Pixels | Resolution Type: Full HD+ | GPU: Adreno GPU | Display Type: Full HD+ AMOLED Display, 120 Hz Refresh Rate | Operating System: Android 13 | Processor Type: Qualcomm Snapdragon 7+ Gen 2 (4nm) | Internal Storage: 256 GB | RAM: 8 GB | Memory Card Slot Type: Hybrid Slot | Primary Camera: 64MP (OIS) + 8MP + 2MP | Front Camera: 16MP | Network Type: 5G, 4G VOLTE, 4G, 3G, 2G | Battery Capacity: 5000 mAh

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